



LAKEWOOD CITY COUNCIL MINUTES

Tuesday, February 17, 2026

City of Lakewood

6000 Main Street SW

Lakewood, WA 98499

<https://us02web.zoom.us/j/86872632373>

Dial +1(253) 215- 8782 Participant ID: 868 7263 2373

CALL TO ORDER

Mayor Bocchi called the meeting to order at 6:00 p.m.

ROLL CALL

Councilmembers Present: 6 – Mayor Paul Bocchi, Deputy Mayor Patti Belle, Councilmembers Ellen Talbo, Michael Brandstetter, Ryan Pearson and J. Trestin Lauricella.

Councilmember Excused: 1 – Councilmember Philip Lindholm.

PLEDGE OF ALLEGIANCE

Mayor Bocchi led the Pledge of Allegiance.

PROCLAMATIONS AND PRESENTATIONS

Proclamation recognizing the City of Lakewood's 30th Anniversary.

MAYOR BOCCHI AND DEPUTY MAYOR BELLE PRESENTED A PROCLAMATION RECOGNIZING THE CITY OF LAKEWOOD'S 30TH ANNIVERSARY TO BRYAN THOMAS, DAVID BUGHER, ALICE BUSH, BOB WARFIELD, WALTER NEARY, STEVE DUNKELBERGER, KRIS KAUFMANN AND FORMER MAYOR DOUGLAS RICHARDSON.

PUBLIC COMMENTS

James Dunlop, Lakewood resident, spoke about the decline in the environment throughout the city over the past 30 years.

Ken Paulson, Tacoma resident, spoke about the speed and traffic concerns in the area of Steilacoom Blvd by Lochburn Lane and in support of reduced speed limits.

Karen Ness, Lakewood resident, spoke about concerns with the Rental Housing Safety Program.

John Burns, Lakewood resident, spoke about the Volunteer Program related to street ends.

Hallie McCurdy, Clover Park Rotary, invited the City Council to participate in the Clover Park Rotary Invitational fundraising event.

Christina Manetti, Lakewood resident, spoke about the age of the Garry Oak tree in Woodbrook neighborhood and in support of acquiring the property to be preserved.

Christina Manetti, Garry Oak Coalition, spoke about 30 years of environmental destruction throughout the city and lack of environmental protections.

Ebrahim Mirjalili, Lakewood resident, spoke about 30 years of incorporation and referenced recorded documents of his surveyed property.

C O N S E N T A G E N D A

- A. Approval of the minutes of the City Council meeting of February 2, 2026.

- B. Motion No. 2026-12

Authorizing the execution of an agreement with Sound Electronics for modernization of the Fire Alarm Monitoring Panel and Smoke Detection System at City Hall.

- C. Motion No. 2026-13

Authorizing the execution of an amendment to the Interlocal Agreement with Pierce Transit for law enforcement services.

- D. Motion No. 2026-14

Authorizing the execution of an agreement with the Washington State Department of Transportation to return right-of-way to the City of Lakewood.

- E. Motion No. 2026-15

Authorizing the execution of an interagency agreement with the Washington State Department Commerce for the Natural Environment and Climate Change (NECC) Program.

F. Motion No. 2026-16

Authorizing the award of a construction contract to R.L. Alia Company, in the amount of \$630,935, for the 112th Street – Farwest Drive to Holden Road Project.

G. Items filed in the Office of the City Clerk:

1. Lakewood Arts Commission meeting minutes of November 3, 2025.
2. Lakewood Arts Commission meeting minutes of November 7, 2025.
3. Lakewood Arts Commission meeting minutes of December 1, 2025.

COUNCILMEMBER PEARSON MOVED TO ADOPT THE CONSENT AGENDA. SECONDED BY COUNCILMEMBER TALBO. VOICE VOTE WAS TAKEN AND CARRIED UNANIMOUSLY.

R E G U L A R A G E N D A

PUBLIC HEARINGS AND APPEALS

This is the date set for a public hearing on the Engineering Development Regulations, including the Engineering Standards Manual, Lakewood Municipal Code (LMC) Titles 12 and 13, and Chapter 18A.20.

There being no public testimony, the public hearing was declared closed at 6:51 p.m.

ORDINANCE

Ordinance No. 844 Adopting amendments to the Lakewood Municipal Code related to the allowed locations for alcohol production and sales.

DEPUTY MAYOR BELLE MOVED TO ADOPT ORDINANCE NO. 844. SECONDED BY COUNCILMEMBER BRANDSTETTER.

COUNCILMEMBER LAURICELLA MOVED TO AMEND ORDINANCE NO. 844, TO INCLUDE IN THE ZONING CLASSIFICATION TABLE MULTIFAMILY (MF3(1)) PERMITTABLE USE FOR DISTILLERY AND TASTING ROOMS. SECONDED BY COUNCILMEMBER PEARSON. VOICE VOTE WAS TAKEN AND CARRIED WITH COUNCILMEMBERS BRANDSTETTER AND TALBO VOTING IN OPPOSITION.

ROLL CALL VOTE WAS TAKEN ON ORDINANCE NO. 844 AS AMENDED AND CARRIED UNANIMOUSLY WITH COUNCILMEMBER TALBO VOTING IN OPPOSITION.

Ordinance No. 845 Establishing a community volunteer program for the adoption and stewardship of public streets, street ends, and public sites; repealing Resolutions 1996-28 and 1997-13.

COUNCILMEMBER BRANDSTETTER MOVED TO ADOPT ORDINANCE NO. 845. SECONDED BY COUNCILMEMBER TALBO.

COUNCILMEMBER BRANDSTETTER MOVED TO REPLACE THE DEFINITION OF VOLUNTEER GROUP IN SECTION 2.70.020 WITH VOLUNTEER ENTITY. SECONDED BY COUNCILMEMBER PEARSON. VOICE VOTE WAS TAKEN AND CARRIED UNANIMOUSLY.

VOICE VOTE WAS TAKEN ON ORDINANCE NO. 845 AND CARRIED UNANIMOUSLY.

UNFINISHED BUSINESS

None.

NEW BUSINESS

None.

ITEMS FOR DISCUSSION

Unified Regional Approach to Addressing Homelessness.

Planning Manager Tiffany Speir introduced Liza Burell, Uncommon Bridges. Burell provided an overview of the purpose to agree on and provide a unified response to homelessness in Pierce County, she reviewed the project vision, guiding principles, project structure and reviewed the best national practices around effective regional approaches. She then reviewed problems for individuals, service providers and jurisdictions without a unified approach, coordinated activities around data standards, sharing and a universal process of assessment and entry and the implementation timeline. Discussion ensued.

Establishment of a Natural Environment and Climate Change (NECC) Program Advisory Community Board.

Planning Manager Tiffany Speir shared that feedback is requested regarding the Natural Environment and Climate Change (NECC) Program noting that options include adoption of an Ordinance to establish a stand-alone NECC Advisory Board or amending the Planning Commission work plan to allow the Commission to serve as the community advisory board to the NECC Program. After discussion, refining of goals around the establishment of and Advisory Board will be reviewed with the City Council again at a future meeting.

REPORTS BY THE CITY MANAGER

City Manager Russell shared that the Public Safety Advisory Committee has received information on the Automated Traffic Safety Camera Program and have been asked to prioritize locations based on high, medium and low priorities.

He shared that a contract for the Raise Grant will come forward on the March 2nd meeting agenda, meetings with the State Legislative Delegation will be held February 18th in Olympia and he requested the City Council provide feedback on who will travel to Washington, D.C. for meetings with Federal Delegation. After discussion, the Mayor and Deputy Mayor will travel at a date to be determined based on availability.

He announced the following upcoming meetings and events:

- February 18, 6:30 P.M., Planning Commission, City Hall Council Chambers
- February 19, 5:30 P.M., Community Services Advisory Board, City Hall American Lake Conference Room
- February 21, 5 P.M., Caring for Kids Annual Auction, McGavick Conference Center
- February 24, 7 P.M., Fort Steilacoom Neighborhood Association, Idlewild Elementary School
- February 27, 9 A.M. – 1:30 P.M., Puget Sound Regional Council - Working Together: Regional Connections for Local Leaders, 1201 Third Avenue, Suite 500, Seattle
- February 28, 2026, 11 A.M., 28th Annual Asia Pacific New Year Celebration, Tacoma Dome Exhibition Hall, 2727 E. D Street, Tacoma

- March 2, 5 P.M.-7 P.M., Artist Reception, Lakewood City Hall

CITY COUNCIL COMMENTS

Councilmember Lauricella requested that financial impact be added to the items considered on the Consent Agenda and shared that he will attend the Community Services Advisory Board meeting and suggested adding the area around St. Francis Cabrini as a location for an automated traffic safety camera. He shared that he will serve on the Alliance for Sustainable Action Steering Committee.

Councilmember Pearson shared that he looks forward to meetings in Olympia this week.

Councilmember Talbo shared that this week she will attend the Planning Commission meeting and she requested information on what speed studies have been done in the area of Lochburn Lane. She also wished a Happy Lunar New Year to residents.

Councilmember Brandstetter shared that this week he will attend the South Sound 911 Board meeting and the Chief Leschi Honor Walk. He shared that he will be absent from the March 2nd Council meeting. He shared that the Lakewood Multicultural Coalition Gala will be held on March 7th.

Deputy Mayor Belle shared that the Lakewood Multicultural Coalition Dr. Claudia Thomas Gala will be held March 7th at 6 p.m. at McGavick Conference Center. She shared that she will be attending the Caring for Kids auction and thanked those who presented this evening.

Mayor Bocchi shared that he attended the Lake City Neighborhood Association, the Lakewood Lions Crab Feed and he reflected on the improvements that have taken place throughout the city since incorporation.

ADJOURNMENT

There being no further business, the meeting adjourned at 9:14 p.m.



PAUL BOCCHI, MAYOR

ATTEST:



BRIANA SCHUMACHER
CITY CLERK